

My interest in computer science originated from reading novels at a young age. Our teachers introduced us to numerous books while in school, igniting my passion for reading. These stories provided me with bountiful ideas that I would never have thought about and taught me valuable lessons that I still remember. In particular, the Sci-Fi genre has given me the most profound impression out of them all. Reading about fantastic inventions in the future and their impact on the world, both good and bad, made me wonder what new technologies I will be able to interact with when I grow older.

This passion and interest remained with me during secondary school, causing me to sign up for a Robotic Technologies course at the HKU Summer Institute. While there, I learned how to use Arduinos and program them for real-life applications. This course caused me to have an interest in STEM during my secondary school life. During my time at school, I took my spare time learning programming, game design, AI and data analysis using Python and web design through HTML and CSS, facilitating an understanding of software development and giving me ideas of how it may help me in my daily life. Doing this has caused me to understand more about the work that a computer scientist does and makes me realise my interest in the field.

Computer Science has made the world more interconnected and is utilised to assist the world by improving the technology we use nowadays. As such, pursuing a career in Computer Science would allow me to work to benefit society and improve our livelihoods and future. This year, AI has become increasingly prevalent in society. Generative AI has caused a paradigm shift, permanently changing how we live and work in this new age, especially in IT. This fact has made me realise AI's potential for good and harm to our future, which has solidified my interest in this field, cultivating my interest in potentially doing research in this field if I can pursue a postgraduate degree, helping shape this field to benefit humanity.

Being a student leader in the STEM team has also given me valuable experiences. Teaching primary school students about coding has helped me contribute to my school and reinforce my coding knowledge. Through working in the STEM team, I have become more proficient in communicating and working with my clubmates, collaborating to build and create projects, troubleshooting bugs and mistakes, and discussing improving our work. In addition, I could interact with new technologies such as Artificial Intelligence, particularly Machine Learning. As Computer Science is a field where group work is integral for success, this skill would benefit me immensely when working with others, improving the efficiency and quality of our work.

I was also a manager of the school cafe for five years as I wanted to give back to the school and my classmates; I understood the importance of organisation and planning when working in an establishment. I have acquired leadership and management skills, facilitating the daily workflow and contacting suppliers.

However, during my time in IB, my eczema and allergies suddenly flared up and became more serious. As such, my academic performance suffered, and I got a drastically lower score in IB than in IGCSE. Realising how health has hampered my work and future, I understood the importance of healthcare in society, causing me to want to use cutting-edge technology such as AI and IoT to develop innovations to help people afflicted with health complications.

In conclusion, Computer Science has been a major part of my childhood, shaping me into what I am today. As such, being at the forefront of technological innovation has been a dream of mine since childhood, intending to participate in creating software that can impact the world in a significant manner. As the saying goes, Shoot for the Moon. Even if you miss, you will land among the stars". Even if I ultimately fail in this goal, I will still choose to learn Computer Science and try to use this knowledge to benefit the world. As such, I hope you can accept me into your university, especially for the AISTN program.